

- **Section B – Transactional writing:** explore and develop transactional writing skills, for example letters, articles, reviews.

The learning outcomes below are drawn from the *GCSE Subject Level Conditions and Requirements for English Language*, published April 2014.

Learning outcomes		Students will:
2.1 Reading	2.1.1	read and understand a range of non-fiction texts, including whole texts and unseen texts
	2.1.2	<i>critical reading and comprehension:</i> identify and interpret themes, ideas and information in a range of literature and other high-quality writing; read in different ways for different purposes, and compare and evaluate the usefulness, relevance and presentation of content for these purposes; draw inferences and justify these with evidence; support a point of view by referring to evidence within the text; identify bias and misuse of evidence, including distinguishing between statements that are supported by evidence and those that are not; reflect critically and evaluatively on text, use the context of the text and draw on knowledge and skills gained from wider reading; recognise the possibility of different responses to a text
	2.1.3	<i>summary and synthesis:</i> identify the main theme or themes; summarise ideas and information from a single text; synthesise from more than one text
	2.1.4	<i>evaluation of a writer's choice of vocabulary, form, grammatical and structural features:</i> explain and illustrate how vocabulary and grammar contribute to effectiveness and impact, use linguistic and literary terminology accurately to do so and pay attention to detail; analyse and evaluate how form and structure contribute to the effectiveness and impact of a text
	2.1.5	<i>compare texts:</i> compare two or more texts critically with respect to the above.

Learning outcomes		Students will:
2.2 Writing	2.2.1	<i>produce clear and coherent text:</i> write accurately and effectively for different purposes and audiences: to describe, narrate, explain, instruct, give and respond to information, and argue; select vocabulary, grammar, form, and structural and organisational features judiciously to reflect audience, purpose and context; use language imaginatively and creatively; using information provided by others to write in different forms; maintaining a consistent point of view; maintaining coherence and consistency across a text
	2.2.2	<i>write for impact:</i> select, organise and emphasise facts, ideas and key points; cite evidence and quotation effectively and pertinently to support views; create emotional impact; use language creatively, imaginatively and persuasively, including rhetorical devices (such as rhetorical questions, antithesis, parenthesis).

Content

Students should read a variety of high-quality, challenging non-fiction and literary non-fiction, in preparation to respond to unseen 20th- and 21st-century non-fiction in the examination. They should be able to read substantial pieces of writing, including whole and extended texts, that make significant demands in terms of content, structure and the quality of the language. Throughout the qualification, students should develop the skills of interpretation, analysis and evaluation.

Text types studied should include a range of non-fiction forms, such as journalism (for example articles and reviews), speeches, journals and reference book extracts. Text types should also include literary non-fiction, such as selections from autobiography, letters, obituaries and travel writing. These lists are not exhaustive. Texts that are essentially transient, such as instant news feeds and advertisements will not form part of the assessment.

The Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) English Language Unseen Preparation Anthology is a resource that supports teachers by providing indicative examples of different types of non-fiction. Examples are indicative only and students should read widely. Students should use what they have learned about different text types to feed into their transactional writing. They should be introduced to, and be given the opportunity to practise, a range of non-fiction writing techniques planning and proofreading skills. The transactional text types that students will be asked to write are:

- article
- letter
- review

Spoken Language Endorsement

Overview

The focus of this component is on developing spoken language skills.

Content

The learning outcomes below are drawn from the Ofqual 'GCSE Subject Level Conditions and Requirements for English Language and Certificate Requirements' document published July 2015 and available on the Ofqual website.

Learning outcomes		Students will:
3.1 Spoken language	3.1.1	<i>presenting information and ideas:</i> selecting and organising information and ideas effectively and persuasively for prepared spoken presentations; planning effectively for different purposes and audiences; making presentations and speeches
	3.1.2	<i>responding to spoken language:</i> listening to and responding appropriately to any questions and feedback
	3.1.3	<i>spoken Standard English:</i> expressing ideas using Standard English whenever and wherever appropriate.

Content

Students must demonstrate their presentation skills in a formal setting, listen and respond to questions and feedback, and use spoken English effectively.

Presentation:

The spoken language presentation is to be completed individually by a student and may take a variety of forms, including:

- (a) a speech or talk by a student, followed by questions from the audience or
- (b) a formal debate or dialogue, such as an interview where the student is able to prepare extended responses to questions or prompts which have been shared in advance, followed by questions from the audience.

In all cases, the presentation should be prepared and last no longer than 10 minutes per student and this includes questions and answers.

Centres should be mindful of the comparability of presentations they allow students to undertake. They are encouraged to take steps to ensure that all tasks undertaken in their centre are of comparable demand.

Audience:

Students must give their presentations to an audience, which must always include the teacher and we recommend the audience consist of at least two people as this gives greater opportunities for students to demonstrate the necessary knowledge, skills and understanding for this assessment. **The composition of the audience must** also provide students with opportunities to respond to appropriate questions and feedback.

The size and composition of the audience should be determined by the teacher, in discussion with the student. However, where the audience is the teacher only, the presentation and dialogue should be designed in such a way that it could have a potentially wider audience than just one person (for example, it replicates a television interview).

Assessment criteria

Students should be assessed either live or from recordings.

There are no marks for the Spoken Language endorsement. Students should be awarded a grade (Pass, Merit or Distinction) using the assessment criteria below. Students who do not reach the Pass standard, or who do not attempt the assessment, must be recorded as Not Classified. This grade will appear on the student's certificate.

In order to achieve a particular grade, a student must meet all of the criteria for that grade.

For more information on grading see the Awarding and Reporting section.

General criteria		
To be awarded a Pass, Merit or Distinction a student must:		
• be audible, and • use spoken Standard English which, for the purposes of the spoken language assessment, means that a Learner must: ◦ be intelligible, and ◦ generally use language appropriate to the formal setting of the presentation.		
Pass	Merit	Distinction
In addition to the general criteria, to be awarded a Pass a Learner's performance in his or her spoken language assessment must meet all of the following criteria – • expresses straightforward ideas/information/feelings, • makes an attempt to organise and structure his or her presentation, • makes an attempt to meet the needs of the audience, and • listens to questions/feedback and provides an appropriate response in a straightforward manner.	In addition to the general criteria, to be awarded a Merit a Learner's performance in his or her spoken language assessment must meet all of the following criteria – • expresses challenging ideas/information/feelings using a range of vocabulary, • organises and structures his or her presentation clearly and appropriately to meet the needs of the audience, • achieves the purpose of his or her presentation, and • listens to questions/feedback responding formally and in some detail.	In addition to the general criteria, to be awarded a Distinction a Learner's performance in his or her spoken language assessment must meet all of the following criteria – • expresses sophisticated ideas/information/feelings using a sophisticated repertoire of vocabulary, • organises and structures his or her presentation using an effective range of strategies to engage the audience, • achieves the purpose of his or her presentation, and • listens to questions/feedback, responds perceptively and if appropriate elaborates with further ideas and information.

Re-use (carry forward) of Spoken Language grades

A student who is re-taking GCSE English Language (post-16) may re-use a previous result for the Spoken Language Endorsement, even if it was awarded by another awarding body.

The result for the Spoken Language Endorsement may be transferred even if the overall grade at GCSE achieved is unclassified.

External monitoring

Each centre is required to provide audio-visual recordings of the presentations of a sample of students, that is representative of the various teaching groups. There is no requirement to record the presentations of all students.

For further information, please see the *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments* document, which is available on the [JCQ website](#) and Pearson's *Administrative Support Guide (ASG): Instructions for the Conduct of Spoken Language Endorsement* available on our website: qualifications.pearson.com.

Head of centre declaration

Heads of centres are required to complete the declaration in Appendix 2. This form must be submitted at this at the same time as the sample of students' recordings. Failure by a centre to provide a Head of Centre Declaration may be treated as malpractice or maladministration (see Section 3 *Administration and general information* section for more information).

Assessment record sheet

An assessment record sheet (see *Appendix 1*) should be completed for each student and kept securely by the centre. The assessment record sheets of the sampled students must be sent to Pearson.

Guidance on making and submitting audio-visual recordings for the Spoken Language Endorsement

1. Recording of the presentation

The presentation should be saved digitally. Each recording must be saved individually and not as one long recording of multiple students. The recording must be made under controlled conditions ^[1]. It must be a complete, unedited recording of each performance. The presentations can be undertaken by students and recorded by the centre at any time during the course.

The camera must be positioned to ensure the best possible sound and visual quality. The centre must ensure that the camera is not obscured, for example by the backs of people's heads.

At the start of each performance the candidate must state their full name. There is a requirement for an audience of at least one person, which can be the teacher, to be present during the recording. The audience must include the teacher.

The recording must be readable through one of the following programmes: Windows Movie Maker, Real Time, VLC or Quicktime. We advise that you save the recordings in one of the following file types: MPEG, FLV, MOV, WMV or RM.

Recordings should then be securely stored until it is time to submit the sample to Pearson. Once the sample is submitted, a monitor, whose responsibility it will be to ensure that the centre's assessment is in line with the national standard, will review the centre's submission.

2. Preparation of material

Presentation recordings

You must submit the recording of the presentation/s digitally to Pearson. Each recording file must be created in the following way:

- create a file for each student.
- name each file according to the following naming convention:
[centre #]_[candidate number #]_[surname]_[first letter of first name]_[grade]
Example: Joshua Smith with candidate number 7890 at centre 12345 would a recording titled, '12345_7890_Smith_J_Merit'

It is the centre's responsibility to check all performances on a computer before sending to Pearson. You must ensure the quality of the sound and picture of the recordings is sufficient to enable performances to be marked. Before the recordings are sent for review, the teacher should check that:

- the files submitted play on all computers/operating systems. For instance, if the recording was created on an Apple Mac computer, you must check that they can be opened on a Microsoft Windows computer.

Assessment sheets

Centres are provided with an assessment record sheet for use in assessing students' performances.

One record sheet should be completed for each student.

All forms should be retained securely, and the sampled students' sheets must be sent to Pearson.

Head of Centre declaration

The Head of Centre Declaration (see *Appendix 2: Spoken Language Endorsement: Head of Centre Declaration*) should be submitted at the same time as the sampled students' recordings.

The form must be named according to the following naming convention:

- [centre #]_[SLE head of centre declaration]
- example: centre 12345 would have a declaration titled, '12345_SLE head of centre declaration'.

All materials – recordings of all student presentations and assessment sheets and the Head of Centre Declaration – should be stored securely until after the review of marking period.

3. Submission of work

All the sampled students' presentation recordings and assessment sheets, and the Head of Centre Declaration, must be submitted digitally. Documents can be submitted in either Word or PDF formats.

Recordings of student presentations and assessment sheets should be stored securely until you are required to submit them.

Submission checklist:

- backup copies made and stored securely
- assessment record sheet completed correctly for each student sampled
- Head of Centre Declaration completed correctly.

Submission requirements

No. of students at centre	No. of students whose presentations must be recorded	Minimum no. of students at each grade (D, M, P)+
30 or fewer	All students	10 ⁺⁺
Over 30	30	10 ⁺⁺⁺

The sample should be representative of the teaching groups within the centre.

- + All students at a grade if the centre has fewer than the stated minimum. Students assessed as Not Classified should not be included.
- ++ For example, if a centre has 15 D students, 11 M students and 3 P students, all of these students will be in the sample.
- +++ For example:
 - (a) if a centre has 21 D students, 14 M students and 3 P students, the sample will consist of 10 of the D students, 10 of the M students and all of the P students, with 7 additional students (from D and/or M) to make the overall sample up to 30.
 - (b) if a centre has no D students, 7 M students and 60 P students, the sample will consist of all of the M students and 23 of the P students.

^[1] Please see the JCQ Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE & GCSE specifications).

Awarding and reporting

This qualification will be graded, awarded and certificated to comply with the requirements of Ofqual's General Conditions of Recognition.

This GCSE qualification will be graded and certificated on a nine-grade scale from 9 to 1 using the total subject mark where 9 is the highest grade. Individual papers are not graded. Students whose level of achievement is below the minimum judged by Pearson to be of sufficient standard to be recorded on a certificate will receive an unclassified U result.

The result of the Spoken Language Endorsement will be reported separately from a student's English Language result, and where a certificate is issued, be recorded as a separate line on the certificate.

A pass, merit or distinction result will be recorded on a certificate when a student also achieves a 9–1 grade for the GCSE.

Students who do not receive a pass, merit, distinction result for the Spoken Language Endorsement, but achieve a 9–1 grade for GCSE, will be awarded a 'not classified' and this is what will be recorded separately on their certificate.

If a student achieves the required standard for the Spoken Language Endorsement but does not achieve a 9–1 grade for GCSE, both results will be issued, but no certificates will be issued. However, the result for the Spoken Language Endorsement may be transferred even if the overall grade at GCSE achieved is unclassified.

The first certification opportunity for this qualification will be 2022.

Malpractice

Candidate malpractice

Candidate malpractice refers to any act by a candidate that compromises or seeks to compromise the process of assessment or which undermines the integrity of the qualifications or the validity of results/certificates.

Candidate malpractice in controlled assessments discovered before the candidate has signed the declaration of authentication form does not need to be reported to Pearson.

Candidate malpractice found in controlled assessments after the declaration of authenticity has been signed, and in examinations **must** be reported to Pearson on a *JCQ Form M1* (available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice).

The form should be emailed to candidatemalpractice@pearson.com. Please provide as much information and supporting documentation as possible. Note that the final decision regarding appropriate sanctions lies with Pearson.

Failure to report candidate malpractice constitutes staff or centre malpractice.

Staff/centre malpractice

Staff and centre malpractice includes both deliberate malpractice and maladministration of our qualifications. As with candidate malpractice, staff and centre malpractice is any act that compromises or seeks to compromise the process of assessment or undermines the integrity of the qualifications or the validity of results/certificates.

All cases of suspected staff malpractice and maladministration **must** be reported immediately, before any investigation is undertaken by the centre, to Pearson on a *JCQ Form M2(a)* (available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice).

The form, supporting documentation and as much information as possible should be emailed to pqsmalpractice@pearson.com. Note that the final decision regarding appropriate sanctions lies with Pearson.

Failure to report malpractice itself constitutes malpractice.

More-detailed guidance on malpractice can be found in the latest version of the document *General and Vocational Qualifications Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments Policies and Procedures*, available at www.jcq.org.uk/exams-office/malpractice.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examined assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* document on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

Assessment

Assessment summary tables

Students must complete all assessment in the same series.